The Single Recollection of Hevajra

Hevajra Ekasmṛti · Toh 1236 · Derge Tengyur

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The Single Recollection of Hevajra, known in Sanskrit as the Hevajra Ekasmṛti and in Tibetan as Kyé Dorjé Drenpa Chikpa, is a short verse practice manual (sādhana) for the meditation deity Hevajra, attributed in its colophon to the Indian master Garbharipa. It sets out a concise daily practice in which the yogin, after preparing a small maṇḍala and offerings, goes for refuge, cultivates the four immeasurables, and generates himself as Heruka through the stages of approach and accomplishment, then turns to empowerment, the subtle channels and inner fire, mantra recitation, the nectar offering and the torma offering. It is Toh 1236 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the tantra commentaries section among the works of the Hevajra cycle, and it was translated into Tibetan by the Indian abbot Prajñendraruci and the monk Shākya Yeshé.

In the language of India: he vajra eka smṛti. In the language of Tibet: The Single Recollection of Hevajra.

Homage to glorious Vajrasattva.

Having understood what is to be done and what is not,
The yogin who practices,
In his own dwelling, secluded and pleasant,
At night, on a maṇḍala one cubit across,
Should arrange heaps of scents and flowers,
And prepare tormas as well, in measure with his means,
And then with faith he should surely meditate.
At the heart, upon a lotus and a sun from vaṃ and raṃ,
From hūṃ arises the venerable lord in the sky.
Visualizing him with one face and two arms,
Worship him with outer, inner and secret offerings.
After confessing wrongdoing, going for refuge and rejoicing,
First one should cultivate loving-kindness;
Second, one cultivates compassion;
Third, one cultivates joy;
And after all of these, equanimity.
Then again: first, the awakening of emptiness;
Second, gathering the seed;

Third, the form complete;
Fourth, setting out the syllables.
In front, visualize a sun from raṃ.
On that sun hūṃ arises, becoming a crossed vajra,
And with that very vajra one should visualize
The fence and the canopy, firmly bound together.
At the center of an eight-petaled lotus from paṃ
One should first visualize a corpse,
Conceiving it as the very nature of the sphere of reality (dharmadhātu).
Upon it the yogin himself
Meditates on himself as Heruka.
At his heart, from raṃ, a disc of the sun;
Upon it, from that, hūṃ itself,
Which is the very nature of method and wisdom,
Black in color and greatly terrifying.
From hūṃ generate a vajra perfectly;
Dwelling at the center of the vajra's hub,
One should meditate on the reality of hūṃ.
From the transformed hūṃ one should behold him:
Blue, with a slightly reddish hue,
His eyes like red bandhūka flowers,
His hair bristling upward, yellow.
With wheel, earrings and necklace,
Bracelets and girdle,
Through the purity of the five aggregates
Purified as the five buddhas,
He is adorned with the five kinds of mudrā.
Appearing sixteen years of age, in his left hand
He holds a skull cup marked with a vajra,
And the khaṭvāṅga rests in between;
In his right he holds a black vajra.
Through hūṃ complete and clear, the bodily form is complete,
Trampling the corpse. After the approach is complete,
The close approach: the wisdom being,
And the samādhi being endowed with hūṃ.
By emanating and gathering oṃ and āḥ hūṃ,
Firmly bless them as body, speech and mind.

With the circle of the pledge being clear,
Dissolve into it the circle of wisdom from all directions and times.
That accomplishment is itself the great accomplishment.
Inviting the gurus and sugatas,
After they are worshipped by those who have become mātṛkās,
Saying abhiṣiñcatu māṃ sarva tathāgata,
They become Herukas,
And, filled with the five nectars of the sugatas,
Confer empowerment by means of golden vases.
Incense and the rest fall as rain, the sound of hūṃ resounds;
Offering forms and so forth, one praises with song.
After the offering, they become one's own family.
All is nondual wisdom,
And that itself is the very nature of Heruka.
After meditating on the blessing in four sessions,
The fire of Brahmā, which is oṃ itself,
Imagine at the place of the nirma cakra,
The lotus of sixty-four petals.
At the place of the suga cakra,
The indestructible drop, the syllable haṃ,
Visualize at the center of the thirty-two.
Set in motion by the winds of karma,
The fire of Brahmā blazes at the triple junction.
The stream of mind produced from the tilaka,
Of the measure of a horsehair split a hundredfold,
One should gaze upon as sleepless wisdom.
Lalanā, rasanā and avadhūtī,
The three channels whose flows are distinct,
Are musk, saffron and camphor.
At the places of the navel and the throat,
The coemergent constantly,
The excellent bliss of the Father, descends.
One's own bliss is buddhahood itself;
Buddhahood cannot be shown anywhere else.
In all one's conduct, keep the deity's samādhi in mind;
Since it abides by its very nature, it is not something meditated upon.
Whether by oneself or from another,

The wise one should perform the recitation of the mantra:
oṃ trailokyākṣepa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.
In bathing and in all enjoyments,
As the very nature of empowerment and offering,
Because offering to oneself is foremost,
Offer nectar to one's own deity.
From a, a skull cup; in its center,
From hūṃ, the five nectars, blessed.
Purify them with wind and fire and realize them;
Having raised them up with the syllable oṃ,
At the place of the tongue of one's chosen deity,
From hūṃ a vajra, taste them with hūṃ:
oṃ akāro mukhaṃ sarvva dharmāṇāṃ ādyanutpanna tvāta oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.
Visualize all sentient beings of the three realms
And bless them as the Dharma body.
With the baliṃ mantra purify the torma into nectar;
With jihva hūṃ, a vajra, hūṃ;
With sarayana they are drawn in and satisfied.
In order to pacify obstacles and the like,
One should give torma continually.
At the time of dissolution, the tilaka
Is the very nature of the Dharma body.
From the ocean-like Hevajra,
For the sake of those of feeble capacity and intellect,
I have made this Single Recollection of Heruka;
May the learned be patient with me, of little intellect.
Through the holy scripture received from my guru
And having heard many explanatory tantras,
Whatever merit has arisen from this composition,
By it may beings go to the stage of buddhahood.

The Single Recollection of Hevajra, composed by the master Garbharipa, is complete. It was translated, edited and finalized by the Indian abbot Prajñendraruci and the monk Shākya Yeshé.

Translator's Notes

• "The venerable lord in the sky" renders nam mkha' rje btsun literally; the line may describe the guru or deity visualized in space, and its relation to the lotus and sun at the heart is unclear. Line 2 of the liturgy reads phyin nang, evidently a slip for phyi nang, "outer and inner." In the second occurrence, tshang ba'i me ("complete fire") is read as tshangs pa'i me, "the fire of Brahmā," matching the earlier line. "Golden vases" renders gser gyi sgo nas, literally "by way of gold." "Sleepless wisdom" keeps gnyid med as written, though gnyis med, "nondual," may be intended. The line ni rang su 'am gzhan las is obscure; it is rendered "whether by oneself or from another." The translator's name, spelled prajñā a andri ruci, is taken as Prajñendraruci. The sequence approach, close approach, accomplishment and great accomplishment refers to the four branches of practice (sevā, upasevā, sādhana, mahāsādhana); the four awakenings listed after the four immeasurables are the stages of deity generation taught in the Hevajra Tantra.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.